Name: .....
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الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University
Faculty of Language Studies

Arab Open University

FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

EL122
Writing Research
Makeup – All Branches
MTA Exam
Summer Semester 2026
Date:13 August 2026
12:00 – 1:30

umber of Exam Pages: 8 cluding this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 1.5 hours**

Instructions

e sure you complete all the necessary information such as your name, your registration numb
ır section number on this cover sheet
exam has 3 parts
ers must be written neatly and legibly
d some time at the end to revise your spelling and grammar

Part A	/15	
Part B	/8	
Part C	/7	
Total	/30	

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PART A: [15 Points]

Read the following passage and respond to the prompts that follow it:

For many university students, part-time employment has become an important part of student life. Rising educational expenses and living costs have encouraged many students to seek employment while completing their studies. Part-time jobs provide financial support and can reduce dependence on family members or student loans. In addition, employment allows students to gain practical experience that may improve their future career opportunities.

Working while studying can also help students develop valuable skills. Employees often learn how to communicate effectively, manage responsibilities, solve problems, and work as part of a team. These experiences may complement classroom learning and help students become more prepared for the professional world. Employers frequently value candidates who can demonstrate both academic achievement and real-world work experience.

However, balancing employment and academic responsibilities can be difficult. Students who work long hours may have less time available for studying, completing assignments, or participating in campus activities. Fatigue and stress can affect concentration and academic performance, particularly during examination periods. Some students may find themselves struggling to meet both workplace and university expectations simultaneously.

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Experts suggest that success depends largely on effective time management. Students who carefully organize their schedules are often better able to maintain strong academic performance while benefiting from work experience. Universities have also introduced support services, including academic advising and flexible scheduling options, to help working students manage their responsibilities more effectively.

Although part-time employment presents challenges, it can provide significant benefits when approached thoughtfully. The experience gained through work often extends beyond financial rewards and contributes to personal growth, professional development, and greater independence. For many students, the ability to balance work and study successfully becomes an important achievement that prepares them for future responsibilities and career demands.

Khalid Al-Nasser, "The Working Student Experience"

1. What is the topic of this passage? [2 Points]

_____

2. Write a suitable title for the passage. [1 Point]

_____

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3. Write a research question for the passage. [2 Points]

4. Write a one-sentence summary of this passage. [3 Points]

5. Write a response to this passage. [4 Points]

6. Paraphrase the following sentence from the passage: "For many students, the ability to balance work and study successfully becomes an important achievement that prepares them for future responsibilities and career demands." [3 Points]

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PART B: [8 Points]

1. Pick one of the following topics and write a rough outline for a potential research essay. [6 Points]

- The effects of remote work on productivity and employee well-being.

- Should Students be required to complete community service before they graduate?

- The impact of globalization on local cultures.

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2. Write a thesis statement for the outline that you developed in the previous question. [2 Points]

PART C: [7 Points]

Respond to the following prompts:

1. For each thesis statement, identify the problem and rewrite the thesis statement to be more effective. [2 Points Each]

a. Online learning is popular these days.

Problem:

Revised Thesis:

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b. Water conservation is a necessity.

Problem:

Revised Thesis:

2. Here is an original sentence and two paraphrases of it. For each paraphrase, decide if it meets all three criteria for a good paraphrase. If there is a problem, identify it and then rewrite the paraphrase to make it more effective. [3 points]

Original:

Original:

"Online learning provides flexibility for students, but it requires strong self-discipline and effective time management."

— Noor Al-Farsi, *Learning in the Digital Era* (2023)

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Al-Farsi (2023) argues that online learning is popular nowadays because many people study online.

Does the paraphrase meet all three criteria? Yes / No [0.5 points]

If no, what is the problem? _____ [0.5 points]

Rewrite to improve: _____

(student should indicate if no rewriting is needed). [0.5 points]

Paraphrase 2:

Al-Farsi (2023) explains that although online education offers flexibility, students must manage their time well and remain self-disciplined to succeed.

Does the paraphrase meet all three criteria? Yes / No [0.5 points]

If no, what is the problem? _____ [0.5 points]

Rewrite to improve: _____

_____

(student should indicate if no rewriting is needed). [0.5 points]

End of Exam

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